Architectural Reformation of TASK.md: Establishing a Stateless Governance Surface

1. Operational Context: The "Forever Now" Constraint

This reform transitions TASK.md from a passive log into a **self-correcting control plane**. The legacy implementation allows "sediment" (transient session data, chat artifacts, stale logs) to accumulate, creating toxic few-shot examples for AI agents.

The core objective is strict **Statelessness**. The repository must effectively "metabolize" work:

1. **Ingest** a Dispatch Packet (DP).
2. **Execute** the logic.
3. **Scrub** the surface clean.

Any reference to "chat artifacts," "uploaded files," or "previous conversation context" in the Dispatch Packet violates the **Filing Doctrine**. If a file is not in the dump manifest or the projects/ tree, it does not exist.

2. The Policy of Truth Integration

To enforce this, TASK.md must adhere to strict constraints derived from PoT.md [1]:

- **Filing Doctrine:** Truth exists only in ops/, docs/, and projects/. TASK.md is the only exemption to the "Dirty State" rule during active execution, but it must be scrubbed before the session closes.
- **Generation Mandate:** Agents must *generate* verification outputs. Pre-filled templates (e.g., [ ] Check passed) induce "lazy" compliance and are prohibited.
- **Metabolic Law:** "Forever Now" requires Routing Closeout. A task is not complete until TASK.md is reset to its template state.

3. Structural Analysis & Reform

3.1 The Anchor (Session State)

Reform: The Session State must be a **Pointer**, not a hardcoded value. It directs the agent to the OPEN artifact generated by ops/bin/open.[1] This forces the agent to verify the repo state cryptographically (via git hash) rather than relying on potentially stale text in the file.

3.2 The Contract (Dispatch Packet)

Reform: The Dispatch Packet (DP) writer must **never** reference external artifacts from the chat.

- *Violation:* "Use the code snippet I uploaded."
- *Compliance:* "Reference ops/lib/project/SCAFFOLD.md."

If the context isn't in the repo, the DP writer must fail or request it be added to docs/.

3.3 The Verification (Receipts)

Reform: The "Freshness Gate" (Section 3.1 of TASK.md) was previously overloaded with output requirements. These belong in the **Receipt** section (Section 3.4.5). The Gate checks *entry* conditions (Is the branch correct?); the Receipt checks *exit* conditions (Did we produce the proofs?).

3.4 The Stream (Work Log)

Reform: The Work Log provides continuity *during* the session but must be truncated by ops/bin/prune --scrub at closeout. This prevents history from polluting the context window of future sessions.

4. The Reformed Schema

The following schema implements the **Anchor**, **Law**, **Contract**, **Verification**, and **Stream** zones with the specific corrections requested.

STELA TASK DASHBOARD (LIVING SURFACE)

Status: ACTIVE

Owner: Integrator

Last Updated: 2026-02-11

1. Session State (The Anchor)

Pointer: Session context output (generated by ops/bin/open)

Active Branch: (Must match session context output)

Base HEAD: (Must match session context output)

Context Manifest: ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md (Checked by tools/lint/context.sh)

2. Logic Pointers (The Law)

Primary Constraint: PoT.md (Policy of Truth).

2.1 Governance Pointers

Jurisdiction: PoT.md Section 3.

Git Authority: PoT.md Section 4.1.

Behavioral Standard: PoT.md Section 4.2.

2.2 Execution Pointers (The Toolchain)

Linguistic Precision: tools/lint/style.sh.

Structure Verification: tools/verify.sh.

Context Hygiene: tools/lint/context.sh.

Truth Integrity: tools/lint/truth.sh.

DP Validation: tools/lint/dp.sh.

llms Integrity: tools/lint/llms.sh.

3. Current Dispatch Packet (DP)

DP-OPS-0048: Restore TASK, Include System Regenerative Capabilities...

3.1 Freshness Gate (Must Pass Before Work)

Base Branch: main

Required Work Branch: work/dp-ops-0048-task-system-regen

Base HEAD: ca9b35f9

Preconditions:

- No commits on main.
- Working tree must be clean before execution begins.
- If Base HEAD changes, regenerate gate artifacts and update this gate before proceeding.

3.2 Required Context Load (Read Before Doing Anything)

Read these in order before making edits:

1. PoT.md
2. TASK.md
3. SoP.md
4. docs/MANUAL.md
5. docs/MAP.md

3.3 Scope and Safety

Objective: Restore TASK.md schema and enforce statelessness.

In scope:

-...

Out of scope:

-...

Target Files allowlist (hard gate):

-...

3.4 Execution Plan (A-E Canon)

3.4.1 State (What is true now)

...

3.4.2 Request (What we are changing)

...

3.4.3 Changelog (Planned edits)

...

3.4.4 Patch / Diff (Implementation details)

...

3.4.5 Receipt Bundle (Proofs to collect)

Create storage/handoff/DP-OPS-0048-RESULTS.md with receipts.

Mandatory artifacts:

- OPEN
- OPEN-PORCELAIN
- dump payload
- dump manifest

Receipt requirements:

- Base State: session summary (branch, head, dirty state).
- Verification receipts (copy and paste outputs):
  -./tools/verify.sh
  -./tools/lint/truth.sh
  -...

4. Closeout (Mandatory)

- Execute docs/MANUAL.md Closeout Cycle in order (Verify, Harvest, Refresh, Log, Prune).
- Update SoP.md with a DP-OPS-0048 entry.
- Run Routing Closeout scrub:./ops/bin/prune --dp=DP-OPS-0048 --scrub.

Mandatory Closing Block

(Varied Wording provision applies)

Primary Commit Header (plaintext)

(Generate at closeout; do not pre-fill in TASK.md)

Pull Request Title (plaintext)

(Generate at closeout; do not pre-fill in TASK.md)

Pull Request Description (markdown)

(Generate at closeout; do not pre-fill in TASK.md)

Final Squash Stub (plaintext)

(Generate at closeout; do not pre-fill in TASK.md)

Extended Technical Manifest (plaintext)

(Generate at closeout; do not pre-fill in TASK.md)

Review Conversation Starter (markdown)

(Generate at closeout; do not pre-fill in TASK.md)

4.1 Thread Transition (Reset / Archive Rule)

- Append a THREAD END entry to the TASK.md Work Log at completion.
- Execute Routing Closeout scrub only after all receipts and SoP logging are complete.

5. Work Log (Timestamped Continuity)

2026-02-11 00:00 - THREAD START: DP-OPS-0048.

Seed: Restore TASK... Base HEAD: ca9b35f9.

Verification: NOT RUN. Blockers:...

5. Implementation Logic: The Metabolic Law

The "Self-Correcting" mechanism is driven by ops/bin/prune --scrub and enforced by tools/lint/dp.sh.

5.1 The Semantic Scrub (ops/bin/prune)

This binary must be updated to support the --scrub flag. It performs a regex-based reset of TASK.md [1]:

1. **Sanitize Headers:** Resets DP-OPS-XXXX to DP-XXXX: (Template).
2. **Neutralize State:** Replaces Base HEAD and Active Branch values with placeholders.
3. **Preserve Scaffolding:** Keeps the structure (Anchor, Law, Contract) intact.
4. **Truncate Log:** Deletes all content after ## 5. Work Log... and inserts (No active thread).
5. **Reset Closeout:** Reverts any filled text in the "Mandatory Closing Block" to instruction pointers (e.g., (Generate at closeout...)).

5.2 The "No External Artifacts" Linter (tools/lint/dp.sh)

This linter must be hardened to reject DPs that reference chat artifacts.

- **Logic:** Scan TASK.md for keywords like "uploaded," "paste," "chat," or "snippet above."
- **Logic:** Verify that all file paths listed in the DP exist in the dump manifest. If a path is referenced that is not in the dump (and not being created), fail the lint.

5.3 Infrastructure: storage/tmp

To support the "Scrub," we introduce storage/tmp/ as a repo-controlled temporary directory.[1]

- ops/bin/open, ops/bin/context, and ops/bin/prune must rely on storage/tmp instead of system /tmp.
- ops/bin/prune --scrub deletes all files in storage/tmp (except .gitignore), ensuring no transient artifacts leak between sessions.

6. Verification Matrix

Component	Reformed State	Verification Tool
Receipts	Defined in Section 3.4.5 (Output), not 3.1 (Input).	tools/lint/dp.sh checks for "Mandatory artifacts:" in 3.4.5.
Gate Commands	Removed from 3.1.	tools/lint/dp.sh ensures 3.1 is data-only.
Transient Fields	Scrubbed by prune logic.	ops/bin/prune --scrub
External Artifacts	Prohibited in DP text.	tools/lint/dp.sh regex scan.
Work Log	Truncated to baseline.	ops/bin/prune --scrub

This structure creates a hard boundary between the "Repo" (Canon) and the "Chat" (Ephemeral), enforcing the "Policy of Truth" that **context is a file**, and if it isn't in the file, it doesn't exist.

Works cited

1. dump-full-main-00825f65.txt